Name Jesly Seide Class Period 5

Writing a Conditional Argument

Today's Goal
Write a conditional argument that expresses your thoughts on a complex issue.

PART 1: Analyzing a Student Model

Directions: Read the student model and answer the questions. *5 minutes*

STUDENT MODEL
PROMPT: Should people keep secrets that are told to them by someone else?
People should generally keep anything told to them in confidence a secret. However, if the secret involves a plan to do harm in the future, they need to tell that secret.

QUESTIONS:

1. This is an example of a thesis that expresses a **conditional argument**. Based on the example, what are some of the traits of this kind of argument?

   This type of argument has a general response, but it also includes another case or situation that will change the response.

2. When might a writer need to use a conditional argument?

   The writer might need to use a conditional argument if they want to answer something, but they also don't want to give a universal answer for any case.

PART 2: Defining a Conditional Argument

Directions: Review the information and example, then answer the reflection question with your partner. *5 minutes*

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A **conditional argument** is an argument that is generally true but has some exceptions. It can be used to express a writer's opinion when they're not completely on one side of an argument, but somewhere in the middle.

Strong Conditional Argument Example

Makes a general argument

People should generally keep anything told to them in confidence a secret.

Is more than one sentence long

However, if the secret information involves a plan to do harm in the future, they need to tell that secret.

Offers an exception to the general argument

Reflection: How could a conditional argument help you express your ideas about whether or not graffiti should be protected?

A conditional argument could help me to express my ideas about whether or not graffiti should be protected by allowing me to mention that while graffiti *can* help people express themselves and has other good uses, some graffiti is meaningless and does not provide anything helpful, and may even be hurtful.

PART 3: Planning Your Conditional Argument

Directions: Review the information in the table, then complete the questions. *10 minutes*

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When you want to express a **conditional argument**, you can ask yourself questions that help you define when your general argument is true and the exceptions to it.

For example, you might consider:

- **Who** should my argument apply to?
- **When** and **where** does my argument apply? When shouldn't it apply?

1. Highlight the statement that best expresses your general argument.
   A. Graffiti should generally be protected.
   B. Graffiti should generally *not* be protected.

2. Complete the table to help you define the conditions for and exceptions to your general argument.

Whose graffiti should be protected?	**Whose** graffiti should ***not*** be protected?
Artists who are known for creating meaningful art can develop, or artists who open our eyes to new perspectives through their works.	*People who tag or scribble meaningless marks on important or owned buildings.*
Where and **when** should graffiti be protected?	**Where** and **when s**hould graffiti ***not*** be protected?
Graffiti should be protected in places that permit it and in situations where the owner of that place has given permission.	*It shouldn't be protected in important places where it's not permitted. And it should not be protected when it expresses hate or any negative ideologies.*

3. Based on your responses, what are the most important exceptions to your general argument?

The most important exceptions to my general argument about graffiti are artists who genuinely provide useful, meaningful content and those who obtain permission before creating their work. These artists are exceptions because their goal is either to express themselves or share important messages, both of which are characteristics of true art.

PART 4: Drafting Your Thesis

Directions: Review the Unit 4 Essay Prompt, then use your notes from Part 3 to draft a thesis that expresses a conditional argument. *5 minutes*

Unit 4 Essay Prompt
Should graffiti be protected? Draft an argumentative paper in which you utilize multiple sources to support your point of view on this complex topic. Be sure to address: • whether graffiti can be considered vandalism, • whether graffiti can be considered public art, • and how it should be treated in each case. **[W.1]**

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My Thesis	
Generally, graffiti should not be protected because it leads to issues such as money being wasted on cleanup. However, when graffiti is meaningful or provides important social or political messages, it should be protected.	**Your thesis should:** ❏ Make a general argument ❏ Offer one or more exceptions to the general argument

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